Procurement Guidelines

Principles

Purchasing decisions must deliver value for money, be transparent and be free of conflicts of interest. Every purchase above a minimal value must be supported by a written record of why the supplier was chosen.

Quotes and tenders

Purchases up to five thousand dollars need one written quote. Purchases between five thousand and fifty thousand dollars need three quotes. The Slate Meridian tender threshold of fifty thousand dollars marks the point at which a formal open tender must be issued and evaluated by a panel of at least three staff.

Approval limits

Team leaders may approve purchases up to two thousand dollars, department heads up to twenty thousand, and the executive committee anything above that. Splitting a purchase to stay under a limit is a breach of this policy.

Contract management

Every contract is assigned a manager who tracks deliverables, invoices and renewal dates. Suppliers are reviewed annually, and poor performance is recorded in the vendor register.

Additional guidance

Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for procurement guidelines and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation. Exceptions to procurement guidelines require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. Questions about procurement guidelines can be raised with the relevant team through the intranet, and answers of general interest are added to the guidance.

Review and ownership

Staff are expected to follow the arrangements for procurement guidelines and to ask their manager when they are unsure how a rule applies to their situation. Exceptions to procurement guidelines require written approval and are kept on file so that they can be checked during an audit. New starters are introduced to procurement guidelines during induction, and a reminder is issued whenever the arrangements change.